

RYAN A. DECKER

Chief, Industrial Output & Special Adviser to the Board, Federal Reserve Board of Governors
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, University of Maryland at College Park, August 2015
M.A. Economics, University of Maryland at College Park, December 2013
B.S., B.A. Economics, Political Science (minor Mathematics), Brigham Young University, August 2010

RECENT POSITIONS

Special Adviser to the Board, Federal Reserve Board, 2026-present
Special Adviser to Chair Jerome Powell, March-May 2026; Special Adviser to Governor Jerome Powell, May 2026-present

Chief, Industrial Output section, Federal Reserve Board, 2024-present
Manage roughly 20 staff (13 economists) including career development, task allocation and scheduling, performance reviews, and recruiting
Supervise the section's three major programs:
Monthly publication of Industrial Production and Capacity Utilization data
Tealbook forecast of the industrial sector
Expanded Measurement Agenda for evaluating private sector economic data
Direct staff research related to section responsibilities
Pursue active research agenda in entrepreneurship, firm and labor market dynamics, and economic measurement topics

Special Adviser to the Board (full time), Federal Reserve Board, 2023-2024
Special Adviser to Governor Adriana Kugler
Advised on full range of economic developments and policy decisions
Assisted with FOMC meeting preparation including economic, policy, and special topic "go-round" statements and SEP forecasts
Liaised across Board staff of varying job families and seniority
Monitored daily economic data flow and staff forecast reactions
Conducted special topic analysis of economic and measurement questions
Assisted with public-facing engagements including speech drafting and development
Assisted with governor committee work, especially committees on financial stability and Federal Reserve Bank affairs

Principal Economist, Federal Reserve Board, 2020-2024
Pursued active research agenda in entrepreneurship, firm and labor market dynamics, and economic measurement topics
Managed the staff GDP forecast as "GDP coordinator"
Ran the industrial sector forecast with focus on aircraft, motor vehicles, and oil & gas
Worked on various private sector/nontraditional data initiatives including as a founding member of the ADP-FRB payroll index team
Cowrote special topics for staff forecast materials on subjects including small business employment, inventory investment, labor market measurement, industry concentration, and oil & gas production

Worked on special pandemic projects (individually or on small teams), including:
Analysis of industry small business intensity and pandemic exposure
Business dynamics analysis and forecast
Quantification of coverage needs and gaps related to business lending facilities

Member, Conference on Research in Income and Wealth (CRIW), 2019-present

Adjunct professor, University of Maryland College Park, 2016-2018
Economics of Entrepreneurship (ECON 462)

Economist/Senior Economist, Federal Reserve Board, 2015-2020

Economist, Center for Economic Studies, U.S. Census Bureau, 2011-2015 (Pathways Program)

ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

“Markups and Business Dynamism across Industries.” 2026. *International Journal of Industrial Organization* 105 (April). (With Brian Albrecht). At https://rdeckernet.github.io/website/Albrecht_Decker_Markups.pdf.

“Surging Business Formation in the Pandemic: Causes and Consequences?” 2024. *Brookings Papers on Economic Activity*, Fall 2023. (With John Haltiwanger).

“Boom Town Business Dynamics.” 2024. *Journal of Human Resources* 59 no. 2:627-651. (With Meagan McCollum and Gregory B. Upton Jr.). Previously circulated as “Firm Dynamics and Local Economic Shocks.” FEDS working paper #2020-081.

“Payroll Employment at Weekly Frequency.” 2023. *AEA Papers & Proceedings* 113 (May): 203-207. (With Tomaz Cajner, Leland Crane, Adrian Hamins-Puertolas, and Christopher Kurz).

“Business Exit During the COVID-19 Pandemic: Non-Traditional Measures in Historical Context.” 2022. *Journal of Macroeconomics* 72 (June). (With Leland Crane, Aaron Flaaen, Adrian Hamins-Puertolas, and Christopher Kurz). FEDS working paper #2020-089.

“Improving the Accuracy of Economic Measurement with Multiple Data Sources: The Case of Payroll Employment Data.” 2022. In *Big Data for 21st Century Economic Statistics*, eds. Katharine G. Abraham, Ron S. Jarmin, Brian Moyer, and Matthew Shapiro. (With Tomaz Cajner, Leland Crane, Adrian Hamins-Puertolas, and Christopher Kurz).

“Across the Universe: Policy Support for Employment and Revenue in the Pandemic Recession.” 2021. *AEA Papers & Proceedings* 111 (May): 267-271. (With Robert Kurtzman, Byron Lutz, and Christopher Nekarda).
Note: This is a significantly abbreviated version of FEDS working paper #2020-099.

“Changing Business Dynamism and Productivity: Shocks vs. Responsiveness.” 2020. *American Economic Review* 110(12): 3952-90. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda).

- “The U.S. Labor Market during the Beginning of the Pandemic Recession.” 2020. *Brookings Papers on Economic Activity* (summer): 3-33. (With Tomaz Cajner, Leland D. Crane, John Grigsby, Adrian Hamins-Puertolas, Erik Hurst, Christopher Kurz, and Ahu Yildirmaz).
- “Declining Dynamism, Allocative Efficiency, and the Productivity Slowdown.” 2017. *AER Papers & Proceedings* 107(5): 322-6. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda).
- “Where Has All the Skewness Gone? The Decline of High-Growth (Young) Firms.” 2016. *European Economic Review* 86 (July): 4-23. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda).
- “Declining Business Dynamism: What We Know and the Way Forward.” 2016. *AER Papers & Proceedings* 106(5): 203-7. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda).
- “Market Exposure and Endogenous Firm Volatility over the Business Cycle.” 2016. *American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics* 8(1): 148-98. (With Pablo N. D’Erasmus and Hernan Moscoso Boedo).
- “The Role of Entrepreneurship in U.S. Job Creation and Economic Dynamism.” 2014. *Journal of Economic Perspectives* 28(3): 3-24. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda).

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

- “Can tariffs spur higher factory floor utilization?” 2025. *FEDS Notes*. (With Robin Braun and Fariha Kamal). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econres/notes/feds-notes/can-tariffs-spur-higher-factory-floor-utilization-20251031.html>.
- “Recent patterns of new business creation.” 2025. In *Dynamism and its Enemies*, editor Ryan Streeter. Austin: Civitas Institute at the University of Texas at Austin.
- “High Tech Business Entry in the Pandemic Era.” 2024. *FEDS Notes*. (With John Haltiwanger). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econres/notes/feds-notes/high-tech-business-entry-in-the-pandemic-era-20240419.html>.
- “Rising Markups and Declining Business Dynamism: Evidence From the Industry Cross Section.” 2024. *FEDS Notes*. (With Brian Albrecht). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econres/notes/feds-notes/rising-markups-and-declining-business-dynamism-evidence-from-the-industry-cross-section-20240308.html>.
- “A note on industry concentration measurement.” 2023. *FEDS Notes*. (With Jacob Williams). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econres/notes/feds-notes/a-note-on-industry-concentration-measurement-20230203.html>.
- “Business entry and exit in the COVID-19 pandemic: A preliminary look at official data.” 2022. *FEDS Notes*. (With John Haltiwanger). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econres/notes/feds-notes/business-entry-and-exit-in-the-covid-19-pandemic-a-preliminary-look-at-official-data-20220506.html>.

- “Tracking the Labor Market with ‘Big Data’.” 2019. *FEDS Notes*. (With Tomaz Cajner, Leland Crane, Adrian Hamins-Puertolas, and Christopher Kurtz). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econres/notes/feds-notes/tracking-the-labor-market-with-big-data-20190920.htm>.
- “Book Review: *Big is Beautiful: Debunking the Myth of Small Business*, by Robert D. Atkinson and Michael Lind.” 2019. *Business Economics* 54:145-147.
- “Leaving Money on the Table: Declining Responsiveness and the Productivity Slowdown.” 2018. *VoxEU*. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron Jarmin, and Javier Miranda). At <https://voxeu.org/article/declining-responsiveness-and-productivity-slowdown>
- “Natural Disasters and the Measurement of Industrial Production: Hurricane Harvey, a Case Study.” 2017. *FEDS Notes*. (With Kimberly Bayard and Charles Gilbert). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econres/notes/feds-notes/natural-disasters-and-the-measurement-of-industrial-production-hurricane-harvey-a-case-study-20171011.htm>
- “Unraveling the Oil Conundrum: Productivity Improvements and Cost Declines in the U.S. Shale Oil Industry.” 2016. *FEDS Notes*. (With Aaron Flaaen and Maria D. Tito). At <https://www.federalreserve.gov/econresdata/notes/feds-notes/2016/unraveling-the-oil-conundrum-productivity-improvements-and-cost-declines-in-the-us-shale-oil-industry-20160322.html>.
- “The Decline of High-Growth Entrepreneurship.” 2016. *VoxEU*. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron Jarmin, and Javier Miranda). At <http://voxeu.org/article/decline-high-growth-entrepreneurship>.

WORKING PAPERS

- “Measuring Payroll Employment: A Note on the Current Employment Statistics.” 2026. *NBER Working Paper no. 34924*.
- “Research with Private Sector Business Microdata: The Case of NETS/D&B.” 2020. *Working paper*. (With Leland Crane). Previously circulated as “Business Dynamics in the National Establishment Time Series (NETS),” FEDS working paper #2019-034.
- “Entrepreneurship and State Taxation.” 2018. *Working paper*. (With E. Mark Curtis).
- “Collateral Damage: Housing, Entrepreneurship, and Job Creation.” 2015. *Working paper*.

PERMANENT UNPUBLISHED MANUSCRIPTS

- “Surging Business Formation in the Pandemic: A Brief Update.” 2024. *Mimeo*. (With John Haltiwanger). At https://rdeckernet.github.io/website/DH_businessformation_update.pdf.
- “Tracking Labor Market Developments during the COVID-19 Pandemic: A Preliminary Assessment.” 2020. *Working paper*. (With Tomaz Cajner, Leland D. Crane, Adrian Hamins-Puertolas, and Christopher Kurz). FEDS working paper #2020-030.

“Using Payroll Processor Microdata to Measure Aggregate Labor Market Activity.” 2018. *Working paper*. (With Tomas Cajner, Leland Crane, Adrian Hamins-Puertolas, Christopher Kurz, and Tyler Radler). FEDS working paper #2018-005.

“An Assessment of the National Establishment Time Series (NETS) Database.” 2017. *Working paper*. (With Keith Barnatchez and Leland Crane). FEDS working paper #2017-110.

“Declining Business Dynamism: Implications for Productivity?” 2016. Hutchins Center Working Paper no. 23. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda).

“The Secular Decline in Business Dynamism in the U.S.” 2014. *Mimeo*. (With John Haltiwanger, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda).

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Adjunct Professor, Economics of Entrepreneurship (ECON 462), University of Maryland College Park, 2016-2018

Teaching Assistant, Advanced Econometrics (ECON 588), Brigham Young University, Spring 2010

Teaching Assistant, Intermediate Econometrics (ECON 388), Brigham Young University, Fall 2009

Teaching Assistant, International Relations (PLSC 170/472), Brigham Young University, Fall 2007, Spring 2008, Fall 2008

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2025: NBER Advancing Economic Measurement conference, Conference in Honor of John Haltiwanger, The London Symposium at King’s College London, CRIW Spring conference (discussant), U.S. Census Bureau Center for Economic Studies

2024: NBER Summer Institute (CRIW; discussant), Federal Economic Statistics Advisory Committee (FESAC, discussant), The Austin Symposium

2023: Economic Innovation Group, ESCoE, Brookings Papers on Economic Activity (BPEA), NBER Summer Institute (CRIW; discussant), Kent Macro Workshop

2022: UK-US Working Group on Dynamism & Opportunity, NBER Summer Institute (CRIW; discussant)

2021: Federal Economic Statistics Advisory Committee (FESAC), UNSW CAER Workshop, NBER Summer Institute (CRIW), Brookings Graduate Workshop, OECD Productivity Policy for Places workshop (discussant), ASSA 2021

2020: Banca d’Italia & FRB joint conference on nontraditional data, Federal Reserve System Macro conference (discussant), CAED seminar series, ITAM Business School, NBER Summer Institute (entrepreneurship group), Workshop on Entrepreneurial Finance and Innovation (discussant), New York Fed, Southern Methodist University O’Neil Center, ASSA 2020 (presenter and discussant), Kenan Institute Frontiers of Entrepreneurship

2019: Brookings Hamilton Project, Federal Reserve System Energy Conference (discussant), JPMCC New Directions in Commodities Research symposium (discussant), CAED, Duke/UNC Entrepreneurship Research Conference (discussant), Resources for the Future, York University, Kenan Institute Frontiers of Entrepreneurship 2019

2018: Richmond Fed, Oberlin College, University of Hong Kong, Singapore Management University, Economic History Association (discussant), JPMCC New Directions in Commodities Research symposium, NBER Summer Institute (Entrepreneurship group), OECD/Bank of Canada Global Forum on Productivity, IFN Entrepreneurship and

Innovation workshop (presenter and discussant), Union College, National Association of Realtors, George Mason University, Kenan Institute Frontiers of Entrepreneurship 2018, ASSA 2018 (presenter and discussant)
2017: Brigham Young University, 2017 Federal Reserve System Energy Meeting, 2017 UNC IDEA Workshop, May 2017 Midwest Macro meetings, NBER State Business Taxation Workshop
2016: November 2016 Southern Economics Association meetings, NBER Entrepreneurship and Economic Growth Conference, AREUEA conference (discussant), Drexel University, NBER Entrepreneurship and Economic Growth Pre-Conference
2015: George Mason University, Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis, Federal Reserve Board, Bureau of Labor Statistics, University of Oregon, Brigham Young University, University of Georgia, University of Mississippi, Heritage Foundation Center for Data Analysis
2012-2014: BYU Graduate Student Conference, November 2013 Midwest Macro meetings, 2012 APPAM Fall Research Conference

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee service: *AEJ: Economic Policy*, *AEJ: Macroeconomics*, *American Economic Review*, *AER: Insights*, *BE Journal of Macroeconomics*, *Canadian Journal of Economics*, *Congressional Budget Office draft review*, *Econometrica*, *Economic Inquiry*, *Economic Journal*, *Economica*, *Economics Letters*, *Energy Economics*, *Energy Journal*, *European Economic Review*, *Health Economics*, *International Economic Review*, *Journal of Applied Econometrics*, *Journal of Econometrics*, *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, *Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control*, *Journal of Economic Growth*, *Journal of the European Economic Association*, *Journal of Labor Economics*, *Journal of Macroeconomics*, *Journal of Monetary Economics*, *Journal of Money, Credit, & Banking*, *Journal of Political Economy*, *Journal of Productivity Analysis*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Labour Economics*, *Management Science*, *National Science Foundation*, *National Tax Journal*, *NBER grant proposals*, *Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics*, *Oxford Economic Papers*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *Rand Journal of Economics*, *Regional Science and Urban Economics*, *Research Policy*, *Review of Economic Dynamics*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Review of Economic Studies*, *Review of Financial Economics*, *Review of Financial Studies*, *Small Business Administration draft study review*, *Small Business Economics*, *Sustainability*, *U.S. Census Bureau/FSRDC proposals*

Program and report committees: Conference in Honor of John Haltiwanger (2025), Institute Entrepreneurship Trends Report – Ecosystems Advisory Committee (annual report, 2020), Society of Government Economists (2019) ASSA meetings, Mid-West Macroeconomics Spring Meeting (2017)

OTHER POSITIONS

Research Assistant, Prof. John Haltiwanger, University of Maryland at College Park, 2011-2015
Short-Term Consultant, World Bank, 2011
Research Assistant, Prof. Kerk Phillips, Brigham Young University, 2009-2010
Research Assistant, Prof. Scott Cooper, Brigham Young University, 2008-2010
Intern, Office of International Affairs, U.S. Department of the Treasury, 2009

REFERENCES

John Haltiwanger University of Maryland halt@umd.edu

Ron Jarmin
Christopher Kurz
Scott Stern

Formerly U.S. Census Bureau
Federal Reserve Board
MIT Sloan School

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sstern@mit.edu